



The Incredible Bush Walk

Level 8 · Reading Champion

Our Sounds

Read every sound out loud before you start the story. Then meet this book's new sounds — they're in colour.

ALL OUR SOUNDS SO FAR

ire	ore	ear	oor
ure	tion	ous	able
ible	cious	tious	

TODAY'S NEW SOUNDS

ous	cious	tious	able	ible
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SHIFTY SOUNDS



says /s/
as in **face**



says /oo/ short
as in **look**

Story Words

Sound out each phoneme, then blend. Underlines show letters that work together.

i n c r e d i b l e
· · · · · —

e n o r m o u s
♦ · — · —

c a u t i o u s
· — — —

g o r g e o u s
· — — ♦ — —

r e m a r k a b l e
· ♦ · — · —

p r e c i o u s
· · · — — —

c a p a b l e
· ♦ · — — —

g l o r i o u s
· · — ♦ — —

v i s i b l e
· · ♦ — — —

WATCH OUT — HOW TO SAY

eucalyptus → yoo · ka · lip · tus

kookaburra → kook · a · burr · a

wallaby → wall · a · bee

Mia was ambitious. She stood at the start of the bush walk trail with her brother Tom and their dad, and looked out at the enormous Blue Mountains stretching before them. The famous blue haze hung over the peaks like a glorious curtain of mist. "I am going to spot everything first," she said. "I am the most capable one here." Tom said nothing. He just opened his small notebook and listened.



The trail led them through spacious groves of tall gum trees. Mia strode ahead, pointing at everything she saw. "Look at that gorgeous rosella in the branches!" she called back. "And those enormous cliffs are visible from here — they are famous!" Tom walked behind, slower and more curious. He crouched down beside a fallen log, because under the calls of the birds he could hear something else.



"Tom, you are too slow," Mia said with a sigh. "If you keep stopping, it will be impossible to reach the lookout before lunch." She was not gracious about it. Tom closed his notebook, but he stood still. The sound came back, deep in the bush — a curious song, mixed with the calls of every other bird on the trail. "Something is copying them," he whispered.



Tom crept off the trail, cautious and sensible, placing each foot with care. Behind a thick fern, he saw something wondrous — a lyrebird. Its enormous tail feathers fanned out like a gorgeous silver veil. The bird lifted its head and sang the rosella's call, then the call of a bird Tom could not see, then a sound like a creaking branch. It was performing its famous song, copying every creature in the bush. It was the most incredible thing Tom had ever seen. He held his breath and sketched it in his notebook as fast as he could.



"Mia!" Tom whispered. "Come here — but be flexible and go slowly!" Mia came back along the trail, looking suspicious. But when she crouched beside Tom and saw the lyrebird, her face changed. "That is remarkable," she breathed. "I had no idea it was there." Then the lyrebird sang the rosella's call — the very bird Mia had shouted about — and she went quiet. She was conscious now that she had rushed past something precious. Being fast did not make her more capable — it just meant she had missed the most valuable thing on the whole walk.



After the lyrebird slipped back into the bush, they walked on together. This time, Mia let Tom set the pace. He showed her observable things she had never noticed — a notable pattern in the bark of a gum tree, a web of silk strung across the ferns and the delicious smell of eucalyptus oil hanging in the warm air. "You are admirable at this," Mia said, and she meant it. The glorious view from the lookout was even better when they reached it side by side.



At the visitor centre near the end of the trail, they found a gallery of Aboriginal dot art on the walls — swirling, joyous paintings of the land and its creatures in dots of red, gold and white. Tom held up his notebook and compared his own drawings to the art. "Your sketches are incredible," said Dad, who had been walking comfortably at the back all morning. "You were responsible and patient, and you heard more than anyone." Mia nodded. She was not adventurous in the same way as Tom, but she was learning that his way of seeing was just as remarkable as hers.



That evening, Tom read from his notebook. "Dear Journal. Today was an incredible bush walk. The enormous mountains were visible through the famous blue haze. I was cautious and quiet, and I found a precious lyrebird with gorgeous tail feathers performing its marvellous song. Mia missed it at first, but then she came back and we watched it together. It was the most glorious, wondrous moment of the whole day." He closed the notebook. Mia smiled. "You are remarkable, Tom," she said.

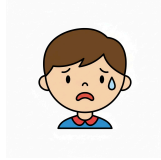


Sound Spotlight

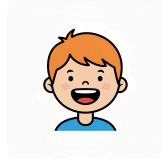
ous



enormous

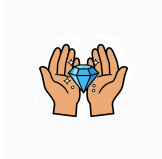


nervous

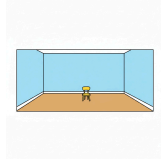


joyous

cious



precious

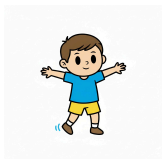


spacious



delicious

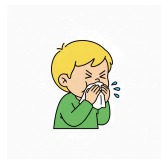
tious



cautious



ambitious

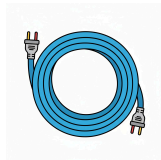


infectious

able



table

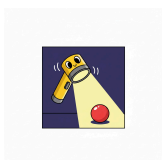


cable

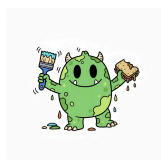


stable

ible



visible



horrible



terrible

Trace & Form the Sounds

Trace the grey letters, then carry on along the line yourself. Say the sound as you write.

ous

o, u, s: says /us/

ous

cious

c, i, o, u, s: says /shus/

cious

tious

t, i, o, u, s: says /shus/

tious

able

a, b, l, e: says /ay-bul/

able

ible

i, b, l, e: says /ih-bul/

ible

NOW WRITE EACH WORD

incredible

Alien Words Challenge

These aren't real words! Use your phonics to sound them out.

blamous

gritious

frocious

strable

plossible

dravious

SOUND DETECTIVE

Say each sound, then find and circle it in its words.

eer

deer

cheer

steer

says /ear/ as in deer

eigh

eight

weigh

sleigh

says /ai/ as in eight

Can You Read These?

Sound out each word, then blend it. Use the buttons under each word.

i n c r e d i b l e
• • • • •

e n o r m o u s
♦ • • •

c a u t i o u s
• • •

g o r g e o u s
• • ♦ •

r e m a r k a b l e
• ♦ • • •

p r e c i o u s
• • • •

READ AND CHOOSE THE WORD

Read each sentence. Which word fills the gap? Circle it.

Today was an _____ bush walk.

incredible

cautious

remarkable

Tom crept off the trail, _____ and sensible, placing each foot with care.

glorious

cautious

enormous

"Look at that _____ rosella in the branches!" she called back.

gorgeous

enormous

cautious

Tell the Story

Number the pictures 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 in the order they happened. Then retell the story out loud in your own words.



Your Turn to Write

Retell what happened in the story. Use the starters and tick a goal as you remember it.

WRITING GOALS — TICK WHEN YOU REMEMBER

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Aa Capital at the start | ☐ ␣ Finger spaces |
| ☐ . ? ! Correct end mark | ☐ ↔ Joining word: and / but / because |
| ☐ “ ” Inverted commas for speech | |

KEYWORDS — USE THESE IN YOUR RETELL

incredible enormous cautious gorgeous remarkable
precious

PARAGRAPH RETELL *At first, ... Then, ... In the end, ...*

At first,

	•
	•
	•
	•
	•

Then,

	•
	•
	•
	•
	•

In the end,

	•
	•
	•
	•

Talk About It

FINDING

What incredible creature did Tom spot that Mia had walked straight past?

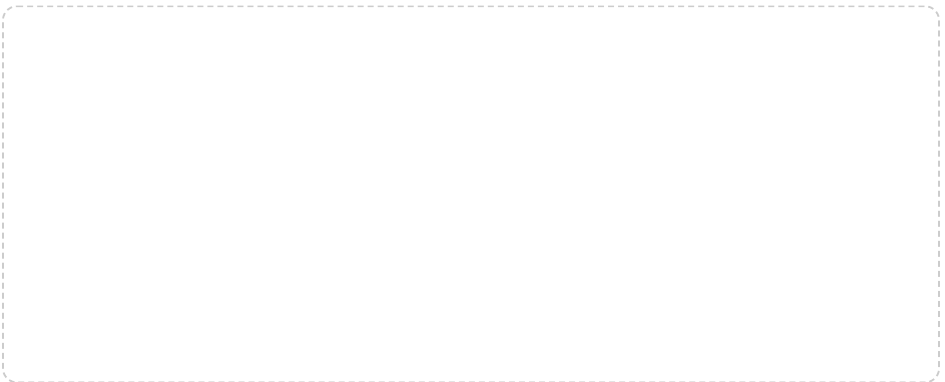
THINKING

Why did Mia change the way she felt about Tom being slow and cautious?

WORDS

What does 'cautious' mean? Why was being cautious helpful for Tom on the bush walk?

DRAW YOUR FAVOURITE PART



It made me feel _____

Circle one:



Shifty Sounds — Grow the Code

Different spellings can make the same sound. Read down each column — every spelling underneath makes the sound at the top. The **faded** spellings are still locked: your child meets those in later books, and the chart fills in as they grow.

CONSONANT SOUNDS

s	t	n	m	d	k	r	h	f	j	v	w	z	sh	ch	th ^{thin}	th ^{this}	ng	zh ^{vision}
s	t	n	m	d	k	r	h	f	j	v	w	z	sh	ch			ng	
ss	ed	kn	mb	ed	c	wr	wh	ff	g	ve	wh	zz	ch	tch	th	th	n	s
c		gn			ck			ph	ge			s	ti					si
ce					ch			gh	dge			se	ci					ge
se					que								ssi					
													s					

VOWEL SOUNDS

a	e	i	o	u	ai	ee	igh	oa	oo ^{moon}
a	e	i	o	u	ai	ee	igh	oa	oo
	ea	y	a	o	ay	e	i-e	ow	u-e
				ou	a-e	ea	ie	o-e	ew
					ey	e-e	y	oe	ue
					a	y	i	o	ou
					eigh	ey			ui
					ea	ie			

VOWEL SOUNDS (CONTINUED)

oo ^{book}	ar	or	ur	ow	oi	air	ear	uh ^{butter}
oo	ar	or	ur	ow	oi	air	ear	er
u	a	aw	ir	ou	oy	are	eer	a
ou		au	er			ere	ere	o
		augh	or			ear		our
		ore	ear					re
		oor						
		oar						
		our						

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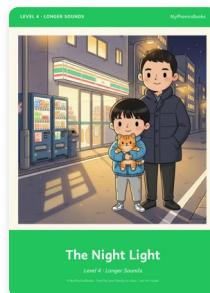
● Level 1



● Level 2



● Level 3



● Level 4



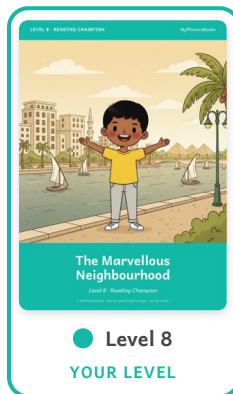
● Level 5



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● Level 7



● Level 8

YOUR LEVEL



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